

GMUFind: Campus Lost and Found
CS 321 - Project Deliverable 00

Group Members:

Name	Email
Idris Barakzai	ibarakza@gmu.edu
Edison Nguyen	enguye29@gmu.edu

Team Leader:

Idris Barakzai

Leader Selection Process:

We selected Idris as team leader because the project idea originated with him. We both agreed that having them lead would help maintain a consistent vision throughout development while incorporating everyone's input. Idris will organize tasks and keep the team on schedule throughout the semester.

Weekly Meeting Time:

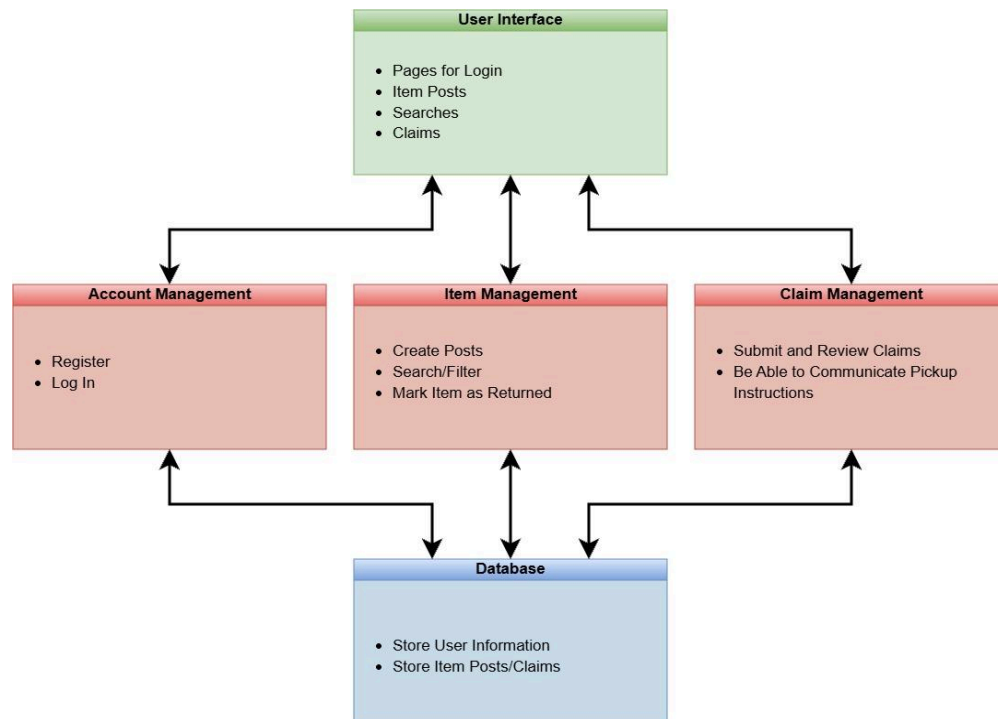
Every Wednesday from 4:00-5:00 PM on campus preferably (may have to meet on Discord some days; subject to member availability)

Product Description:

GMUFind is a web application designed to help George Mason University students find lost belongings and also return items they find stranded on campus. Its intended users are Mason students who have lost an item or found an item left behind by someone else. Students tend to post lost items on the GMU Snapchat story, but those posts do not reach everyone. Items found in buildings such as the library can be turned in at the front desk, while items found in lecture rooms, outdoor areas, or any other place without a designated collection option leave people who lost their items in these places and with no Snapchat completely clueless. GMUFind will provide a central place to post lost items and also a central place for a student who has lost an item to look if it has been reported.

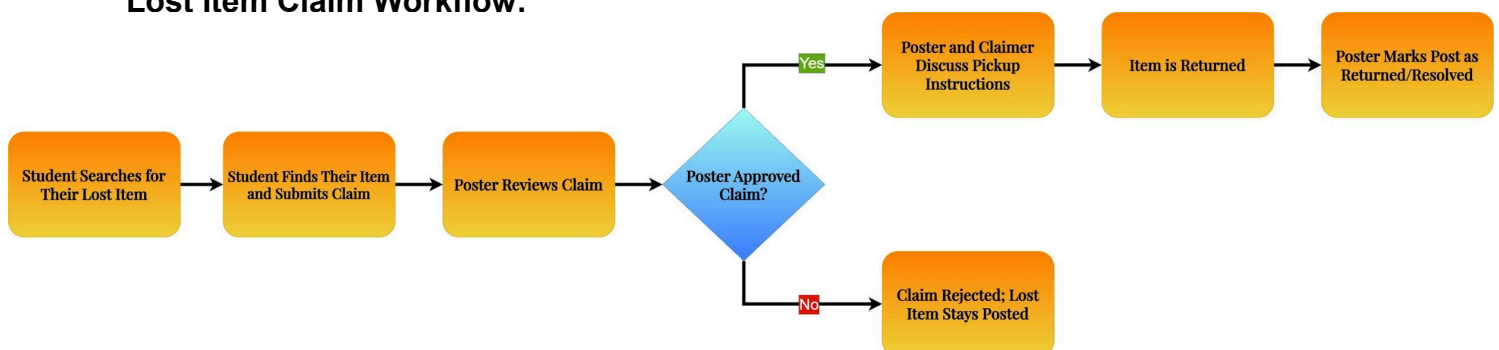
Reported items can also indicate to the user whether an item has been turned in somewhere like a front desk, helping the owner know where to retrieve it. Students will have to register with an email (GMU email if possible) and create a post with a description, photo, item type, date, and location when they find a stranded item. Users can search and filter lost items by item type and location. When a student finds their lost item on a posting, they can submit a claim in which the person who posted said lost item can see their information and review it. If the student who posted the lost item approves of the claim and returns the item, they can mark the lost item post as resolved/found/returned.

System Structure Sketch:



This diagram/sketch shows the main components planned for GMUFind and how they work together. The diagram illustrates how the pages the user interacts with connects to the components that processes requests and stores information/data. For example, searching for an item sends a request to the “Item Management” component, which gets matching lost item posts from the database and returns them to the user’s interface. The components send information going both ways (denoted with the double ended arrows).

Lost Item Claim Workflow:



This workflow sketch illustrates how a poster of a lost item can return said lost item to its owner through GMUFind. The poster (person who posted the lost item they found) reviews the claim made by the potential owner and decides to approve or deny the claim based on the identifying details given by said potential owner. Approval of a claim leads to pickup instructions being arranged and to the post being marked as returned/resolved. If rejected, the post will remain to be listed.

How Valuable This Will Be To Potential Users:

With our web application, students will be able to search for their lost items through a neat collection of user posts that can be sorted by filters to further narrow down the results they are looking for. This will help reduce the need to constantly check all available lost-and-found locations on campus, in the hopes of a particular location holding their item, by giving them the convenience of looking through an organized, up-to-date database of all current lost items that have been reported. The application will be especially useful for students who have no knowledge about where to report their missing item and about the occasional social media posts that could have some information as to the whereabouts of their item.

Possible Features For the Future:

At the moment, this will be the current design of our product, but that doesn't mean it's all the application will be capable of. Some features that our team has considered adding in the future include:

- "Bounty" system that students can set up if there have been no posts regarding their missing item, allowing them to give a description on where they've last had it to give people a general idea on where to search and spread awareness as to what they've lost
- Automated matching system that students can use to search for their missing item more quickly instead of needing to scroll through user posts in the hopes that one of them is about their item

These features are simply suggestions that our team came up with during the design-phase of our application and will be considered if the final product feels lacking in the quality-of-life department. Otherwise, the initial plans and sketches for the product will be our main focus for the time being.